

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE COUNTERFACTUAL
APPELLATE BRANCH — NEVER FILED OR ENTERED ON THE
ACTUAL DOCKET — ISOLATED DOCKET: SYN-CA4-26-CV-4106-CF-
NEVER-OCCURRED**

Never-Filed Corrected-Record Premise and Isolation Notice

Court: United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit **Case:** Open Grid Archive v. United States Department of Energy **Isolated docket:** SYN-CA4-26-CV-4106-CF-NEVER-OCCURRED

Filed: February 10, 2026

This notice defines a counterfactual training premise that never existed in the real or synthetic actual appeal. It creates no filing, order, judgment, deadline, right, or historical fact on the actual appellate docket. The isolated docket printed above is the only location to which this premise belongs.

The exercise asks how appellate analysis would differ if the district record had contained four specified corrections. The operational-decision-tree showing under Exemption 7(E) remains unchanged. The hypothetical 7(F) showing is limited and harm-specific. The segregability account includes a documented line review. The sealing ruling supplies material-specific findings, alternatives analysis, public counterparts, and a defined duration.

All other facts remain those of the single fictional district action and its final judgment. No second district judgment is imagined. The correction does not add a responsive record, enlarge the 200-page FOIA universe, or alter the request and search chronology. It is a bounded adjudication exercise, not a cyber document and not evidence about any actual agency practice.

Actual History Held Constant

Open Grid submitted its request on June 3, 2024. The parties fixed the scope on June 21 after written narrowing and confirmation. DOE searched the fictional Beacon, Driftglass, and Harborline repositories, reduced 16,842 raw hits to 1,284 deduplicated candidates, referred forty-six items for custodian review, and identified twelve responsive records containing 200 logical pages.

The responsive collection remains divided among sixty decision-tree pages, fifty-four escalation-matrix pages, sixty-four coordination-appendix pages, and twenty-two governance pages. Three records comprising fifty-four pages were withheld in full, seven comprising 124 pages were produced with deletions, and two comprising twenty-two pages were released completely. The agency transmitted 146 images.

The actual administrative appeal, district pleadings, declarations, paired exhibits, cross-motions, final memorandum, judgment, notice of appeal, and certified transmission are not rewritten. The final district judgment remains the sole basis for final-decision jurisdiction under 28 U.S.C. § 1291.

Only the corrected propositions stated in this notice may be assumed. A participant may not import an event from the actual appellate course, combine this branch with another never-filed path, or treat an isolated training page as proof of actual history.

Unchanged Exemption 7(E) Showing

The hypothetical correction leaves intact the law-enforcement purpose assigned to Grid Sentinel. The final exercise playbooks were compiled to support prevention of, and coordinated response to, unlawful attacks in the fictional program. Their records function is more than ordinary agency administration, even though every system and event described here is invented.

DOE's unchanged showing distinguishes public knowledge of a general response concept from nonpublic implementation detail. It identifies protected decision predicates, the relative order of review, relationships among abstract branches, and selected guideline fields. For techniques or procedures, the agency relies on the character of those implementation details. For guideline fields, it separately predicts circumvention if an authentic value revealed how a classification changes.

This premise does not turn a title, effective date, revision statement, administrative heading, or general purpose sentence into protected logic. Those portions remain subject to release. Nor does it disclose the content of a condition or order. The protected categories are represented only by public notices or harmless sealed labels.

The corrected branch therefore preserves the same narrow target: withholding of nonpublic trigger order and implementation relationships within the operational decision trees. No party may use this premise to expand 7(E) to every word appearing in a playbook.

Corrected Exemption 7(F) Showing

For this exercise only, DOE performed document-by-document review before grouping retained 7(F) segments. Each segment is correlated to its record, source page, field type, and a stated expected physical-safety harm. The four functional groups are duty assignment, contact category, safety reference, and escalation placement. A segment outside those groups receives no 7(F) treatment.

The corrected account explains that disclosure of an authentic duty assignment could focus interference on a person performing a protective function. A genuine contact category could facilitate misdirection toward that function. A safety reference could reveal which human safeguard an interferer would seek to disrupt. An escalation placement could expose when a protective human function becomes relevant. These are abstract causal descriptions; they contain no identity, method, location, or actionable detail.

Reviewers recorded overlap with 7(E) rather than assuming it. They also distinguished a harmless heading from a value that actually carries the stated function. DOE need not name a threatened individual, but it must connect disclosure to danger to some person. The corrected worksheet supplies that connection for the limited retained segments.

This premise replaces the actual category-level account. It does not validate a blanket assertion that any field near a safety label qualifies under 7(F).

Corrected Segregability Record

The assumed review examines every responsive page and each retained segment in context. Reviewers ask whether visible words convey independent administrative meaning, whether location alone reveals a protected relation, whether a heading survives removal of subordinate content, and whether general coordination prose can be detached from an asserted human-function value.

The responsive universe and production arithmetic remain unchanged. The supplemental production still uses eleven replacement images and reveals seventeen passages: six images receive two passages each, while five receive one each. Decision materials account for six passages on four images, an exercise matrix accounts for three on two, the current appendix accounts for five on three, and the prior appendix accounts for three on two.

For the corrected premise, a page-linked worksheet explains each retention and each release. It confirms disclosure of meaningful titles, ownership lines, revision history, neutral review headings, recordkeeping directions, general coordination statements, closure administration, and approval facts. Remaining omissions are confined to supported conditions, ordering relationships, guideline values, and limited human-function fields.

No new responsive record or source page is added. The correction lies in the affirmative line-review evidence and its correlation, not in altered source content.

Corrected Sealing Findings

The isolated premise substitutes a narrowly reasoned sealing ruling for the aggregate ruling in the actual district history. The hypothetical court gives public notice, identifies the common-law and First Amendment access interests as applicable to the judicial materials, and evaluates each sealed counterpart rather than treating the entire group as one unit.

For each controlled filing, the court finds that only passages displaying inert substitutes for asserted operational or human-function fields require closure. It explains why public release of an authentic counterpart would defeat the interest under review, while recognizing that titles, arguments, authorities, procedural history, and administrative text remain available in a redacted counterpart. Wholesale docket closure is rejected.

The court considers line redaction, a public narrative summary, restricted exhibits, delayed release, and complete unsealing. It selects paired public and sealed copies because that alternative preserves adversarial legal discussion and public monitoring while limiting access to the defined passages. A confidentiality certificate identifies the material and authorized participants.

Sealing lasts only through thirty days after issuance of the appellate mandate, subject to earlier reconsideration for changed circumstances. Continued closure after that date requires a new supported order. These findings are hypothetical and do not repair or alter the actual district sealing order.

Projection and Controlled Access Premise

Every paired disclosure begins in a public-only projection. An unauthorized session resolves the public counterpart and does not resolve the location, digest, size, or existence metadata of the sealed asset. A public reference points to a stable logical subject rather than a sealed physical page.

A court-authorized session event may grant access to one specified disclosure for the exact resolved pack closure. The grant does not extend to another pair, another closure, or another session. Before each authorized open, the controlled asset is retrieved from content-addressed storage and checked for expected path, byte size, digest, readability, and page count. Only then may a leased snapshot be exposed.

Revocation removes the sealed row from the session and immediately restores the public-only projection. No sealed content or location remains in a public result. A certificate records counsel eligible to request access, but eligibility is not itself a grant. The fictional panel and court staff may receive judicial access; counsel Tamsin Roe, Leo Marr, and Corin Pell may receive only the disclosure-specific access authorized for their roles.

These mechanics govern the three brief pairs in this isolated branch. They create no standing access entitlement and no change to the actual appellate record.

Premise Certification and Limits

The four corrections are deliberately asymmetric. The 7(E) showing is held constant. The 7(F), segregability, and sealing records are strengthened only as stated. No other fact may be improved, and no participant may infer that a correction happened merely because it would have been prudent.

The counterfactual appellate question is whether those assumed corrections support affirmance of the four district targets. This notice does not prescribe the panel's answer or create a disposition in advance. The actual course remains governed solely by documents entered on its own docket.

All sensitive-looking terms are synthetic categories. Public notices disclose only a field type. Controlled copies use Condition-Aster, Sequence-Beryl, Value-Cinder, Role-Dovetail, Safety-Echo, and Channel-Fable, none of which has an operational meaning. No source in this branch may add a command, threshold, timing value, contact address, system weakness, or real protective assignment.

I, Teren Wye, acting only as the fictional exercise clerk, certify that this notice identifies the complete corrected premise and its isolation boundary. It was never filed or entered on the actual docket. Executed February 10, 2026.

Teren Wye Fictional Exercise Clerk